

INTERNATIONAL AS **ENGLISH LITERATURE** **LT02**

Unit 2 Place in literary texts

Mark scheme

January 2020

Version: 1.0 Final

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

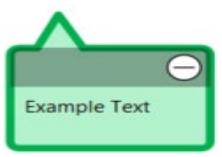
Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 6–8. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
NotRelevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Red Line		 Toolbar Tooltip: Red Line		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text - text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
AssessObjective1		Toolbar Tooltip: Assessment Objective 1		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Vague		Toolbar Tooltip: Vague		Y
Development		Toolbar Tooltip: Development		Y
SomethingHere		Toolbar Tooltip: Something here		Y
Unfocused		Toolbar Tooltip: Unfocused		Y
UnclearExpression		Toolbar Tooltip: Unclear expression		Y
LackOfClarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
FactualInaccuracy		Toolbar Tooltip: Factual Inaccuracy		Y
PartiallyMadePoint		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 17 years old so we are judging their skills halfway through Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	• Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	• Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. • Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	• Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	• Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. • Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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Joseph Conrad: *Heart of Darkness*

'Africa is the only significant place in Conrad's narrative.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significant' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Heart of Darkness* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Africa as the principal setting for Marlow's journey to the inner station
- Africa as the location where the heart of darkness (geographical, metaphysical, or both) is encountered
- London as a setting in relation to imperialism and/or colonialism
- Paris as the place where Marlow's venture begins, and where he meets with Kurtz's bereaved fiancée
- 'Africa' may be challenged as the Congo river and its associated locations are not representative of the whole continent
- Africa as a setting for violence against native people and exploitation of natural resources.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- pervasiveness of darkness motif – Africa, London, Paris
- Africa as central, dominant setting in relation to other places
- contrasts between African and European locations
- structure of journey – progression upriver with climactic events at inner station
- evocation of place through description: eg desolation of first station, the Congo river, surrounding jungle, nightmarish inner station
- ambiguity of Marlow's point of view: eg fascinated but repelled, fulfilment of ambition but horrified
- figurative language, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

A03: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	2
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F. Scott Fitzgerald: *The Great Gatsby*

To what extent do you agree with the view that American society in *The Great Gatsby* is shown as being hopelessly corrupt?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Great Gatsby* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- 'hopelessly corrupt' may perhaps be interpreted as 'entirely corrupt' or 'without hope of change for the better': eg Tom contriving Gatsby's murder, Daisy escaping responsibility for Myrtle Wilson's death
- Gatsby's involvement with bootlegging and his association with Wolfsheim
- a class system that privileges 'old money' and allows the exploitation of lower classes
- decadence: eg Gatsby's parties, Tom's affair with Myrtle, Gatsby's pursuit of a married woman
- 'hopelessly' may be interpreted as 'completely' and challenged: eg Nick Carraway's moral perspective shows American society is not 'hopelessly corrupt'
- Gatsby's idealised love for Daisy
- ambiguity: no social group or individual is untainted, but moral values and behaviour can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- use of different places to present widespread corruption: eg contrast between Long Island and the valley of ashes, New York (Forty-second Street Cellar, Gatsby showing white card to police officer)
- structure that underpins a social critique: eg earlier chapters tend to focus on self-indulgence and exploitation followed by uncovering of corruption with closing chapters focusing on deaths and responses to them
- retrospective view (in the form of a bildungsroman) presented through an unreliable narrator (moral ambiguity)
- use of dialogue: eg racism and sexism expressed through Tom Buchanan, Wolfsheim narrates gangster killings
- methods of characterisation: eg description, speech, actions
- symbolism: eg valley of ashes, Dr T J Eckleburg
- figurative language, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0 3

Kazuo Ishiguro: *The Remains of the Day*

To what extent do you agree that isolation is presented as a central feature of *The Remains of the Day*?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Remains of the Day* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the isolated and enclosed world of Darlington Hall
- the links with the wider world: eg response to events in Europe
- isolation may be seen in positive light: eg interest in life of grand English country house
- isolation of individuals within household: eg despite living and working in close proximity Stevens and Miss Kenton do not become lovers
- Darlington Hall in present (1956) has changed, is a less isolated place
- other aspects that may be regarded as central: eg politics, social class, England between the wars.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- narrow perspective of Stevens as narrator
- use of Stevens' journey through other places to present a retrospective view from outside Darlington Hall
- close focus on a country house as a principal setting
- structural pattern of developing and then failing relationship between Stevens and Miss Kenton
- reference to people and events from history to draw on European background
- lexical choices – particularly for the creation of Stevens' distant relationships and perspective.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	4
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Aravind Adiga: *Last Man in Tower*

'Adiga's narrative shows that the city is changing, but is not becoming a better place to live.'

To what extent do you agree that Mumbai is presented in this way?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Last Man in Tower* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the developments that show the economic development of Mumbai: eg new financial buildings in the Bandra-Kurla Complex
- change that destroys communities: eg Vishram Society becomes embroiled in conflict and is destroyed
- how the narrative of Masterji's attempt to remain in his home shows that change can be devastating for an individual
- how the other residents of Vishram Society accept or are reconciled to change in order to become better off financially
- how Dharmen Shah's building projects may make better places to live, but involve corrupt business practices
- the uncertainty of the benefits of change, even for the poorest: eg Mary will lose her cleaning job, but Muslim man in the slums received 81 lakh rupees for his one-room hut.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the chronological, episodic narrative that focuses on change as it affects one group of residents
- use of Masterji to illustrate resistance to change and allegiance to non-financial values such as the importance of home and loyalty to a remembered family
- use of other characters to present differing motives for accepting change: eg Dharmen Shah to show opportunism and personal ambition, Mrs Puri wanting a better place to live for herself and her son, Mrs Rego's desire to outdo her sister
- contrast between Tower A and more modern developments: eg Rathore Towers visited by the Puris
- use of dialogue to present different attitudes towards change
- figurative language and lexical choices used to portray locations that display change (for worse or for better).

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	5
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Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: *Americanah*

Consider the narrative significance of Adichie's choice of title for this novel.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Americanah* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Nigerian attitudes towards America and its culture
- exploration of meaning of 'Americanah' in relation to narrative
- how living in America affects Nigerian immigrants
- how Ifemelu is affected by her time in America and the degree to which she is an Americanah: eg when she has returned to Nigeria
- America as a focus for aspirations and ambitions and how these reflect attitudes towards life in Nigeria
- how the relationship between Ifemelu and Obinze is affected by her success in America and his failure to get there
- the extent to which the Nigerian attitudes towards America are delusions.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structure: unfolding narrative of Ifemelu's story interspersed with scenes in hair-braiding salon and ending with Ifemelu's experiences in Lagos after her return
- Ifemelu as principal focaliser, but with different perspectives through other characters: eg Obinze, Ranyinudo, Uju
- dialogue: eg conversations in Nigerpolitan club
- Ifemelu's blog
- symbolism of hair braiding
- lexical choices, figurative language.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	6
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Andrea Levy: *Small Island*

'By the end of the novel any reader will conclude that Jamaicans in London will always be regarded as outsiders.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of *Small Island*?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Small Island* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- how Hortense and Gilbert have adapted to life in London and found their own home in Finsbury Park
- undiminished racism at the end of the novel: eg Bernard Bligh ('England for the English') and Mr Todd
- readers will not necessarily see Jamaicans as outsiders even though they have to endure racial prejudice
- novel ends in 1948 so 'always' is unjustified
- how the 1948 sections can be seen to emphasise the Jamaicans as outsiders
- adaptation to living in London: eg Gilbert uses his previous experience and Hortense learns from him and from Queenie.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structure that climaxes with conflict after birth of child with Jamaican father
- final two sentences which may be taken as Hortense's response to racial prejudice
- symbolism of baby, Michael Joseph, entrusted to Hortense and Gilbert by his mother
- different perspectives through different narrators
- use of characters with different attitudes: eg Queenie and Bernard Bligh
- Jamaican dialect
- lexical choices, including racist diction.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0 7

Thomas Hardy poetry selection

Hardy refers to the setting of 'At Castle Boterel' as 'old love's domain'.

Consider the significance of places as settings for love in Hardy's poetry. You should make detailed reference to 'At Castle Boterel' and at least one other poem

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Hardy's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the intense love felt on a particular day and in a particular place eg 'At Castle Boterel', 'Beeny Cliff'
- how 'old love's domain' may not be revisited but love continues in memory at least
- how 'old love's domain' has become a place of loss: eg 'After a Journey'
- the contrast between a time and place of grief with past love: eg 'The Going'
- a memory of love within family in 'The Self-Unseeing'
- love continues, but opportunity for it to be shown lost in the past: eg 'At an Inn'
- a location in the present being the focus for lost love: eg 'Neutral Tones'.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- use of locations: eg 'At Castle Boterel', 'Beeny Cliff', 'At an Inn'
- structure: eg pattern of setting, memory, setting, reflection in 'At Castle Boterel'
- irony: eg through repetition in 'Places' where memory is presented through 'Nobody says... thinks... calls'
- use of contrast between present and past: eg 'After a Journey',
- use of first person and direct address to beloved
- structural use of stanza form and rhyme
- figurative language, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0 8

William Wordsworth poetry selection

To what extent do you agree with the view that Wordsworth idealises locations in his poetry?

You should make detailed reference to 'Elegiac Stanzas' and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Wordsworth's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- idealised view of Peele Castle in lines 1–28
- more realistic response shown in praise of Beaumont painting
- faithful portrayal of boy's destructiveness in 'Nutting'
- idealised family home in 'Michael', but with emphasis on hard work done there and eventual destruction of The Evening Star
- flawless beauty of 'Composed upon Westminster Bridge'
- unsophisticated description: eg 'Daffodils'
- how description of Tintern Abbey and its immediate surroundings may be seen as true to life.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structure of 'Elegiac Stanzas' with contrasting perspective after 'Such in the fond illusion of my heart'
- narrative structure of 'Michael' with loss and death in conclusion
- use of direct comment on own idealisation of Peele Castle
- use of first-person narrative to present a personal view, whether idealised or not
- use of location to present human weakness or folly: eg 'A Narrow Girdle...'
- lexical choices, figurative language
- metre, stanza form, rhyme.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the poems should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0 9

Robert Frost poetry selection

'Frost's poetry is more concerned with the presentation of working life than with the natural world.'

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Frost's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- work as central feature, but may argue that what it reveals is of greater significance: eg 'Mending Wall', 'Out, Out –'
- working life as a stimulus for contemplation: eg 'After Apple-Picking'
- the tramp in 'An Unstamped Letter...' who can, perhaps, engage more profoundly with the natural world than the farmer he addresses
- the concern to present human condition through natural world: eg 'Desert Places', 'Stopping by Woods...', 'The Road Not Taken'
- the presentation of work as tedious or dangerous: eg 'After Apple-Picking', 'Out, Out –'
- the result of work being transient while natural processes persist: eg 'The Wood Pile'.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- narrative structure where description – not necessarily of working life – leads to philosophical observation: eg 'After Apple-Picking', 'The Road Not Taken'
- perspective: eg individual first-person voice in several poems, but also impersonal voice in 'Out, Out –'
- tone – particularly attitude towards reader in presentation of view or comment
- use of speech rhythms
- stanza form
- structural use of rhyme
- figurative language, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

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Seamus Heaney poetry selection

To what extent do you agree that Heaney's poetry is more concerned with the landscape than with the people who live or have lived in it?

You should make detailed reference to 'The Peninsula' and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Heaney's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- attention to details of landscape with little reference to human activity: eg only driving and 'ploughed field' in 'The Peninsula'
- greater emphasis on the nature of the land than with digging through the peat in 'Bogland'
- emphasis on home in 'Anahorish'
- conflict, rebellion and war: eg 'North', 'Requiem for the Croppies'
- significance of bodies: eg 'Bog Queen', 'The Grauballe Man', 'Punishment'
- how response to landscape is changed by love – 'A New Song'.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structure: eg pattern of journey in 'The Peninsula' with three stanzas of description leading to comment; three sections of 'The Tollund Man' – imagined execution in Aarhus, followed by murders at home with conclusion connecting first two sections
- perspective and voice: eg observer in 'The Peninsula', Croppy speaking from his grave, the Bog Queen recounts her own history, voice of history in 'North'
- tone in attitude towards subject matter and/or reader
- use of imagery to evoke landscape and/or people who are part of it
- pattern of rhyme and half-rhyme: eg 'The Peninsula', 'Requiem for the Croppies'
- stanza form
- lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.